

What is it?

Analytics can be defined as the extensive use of data for statistical and quantitative analysis, explanatory and predictive modelling and fact-based decision-making. Analytics closely resembles statistical analysis and data mining, but tends to be based on solving a specific business problem by gathering relevant data and information and analysing it to take an informed business decision.

Analytics is one of the sunrise careers of not just the Indian digital economy but also the global economy. While careers in data mining and analytics have typically been offered by the business process outsourcing sector under the sub-brand of knowledge process outsourcing, increasingly robust demand for analytics professionals has come from information technology firms, banks, telecom companies and other sectors in India.

Why is it needed?

Firstly, the data that is generated by most organisations is bulky and unstructured. This data has to be mined to extract the relevant information. This is an opportunity for “data miners”. Here, you need a smart IT professional to work with software and Excel sheets to bring this data into a readable format.

Once the data has been generated it requires quant (quantitative) skills to analyse and give actionable steps for the organisation. For instance, whether it is the banking industry, insurance, telecom or retail, they do have volumes of data on customers, their transactions, personal details but all of this has

to be analysed by smart minds to give a more engaged customer experience and to increase repeat sales volumes.

The outsourcing industry has made India a destination for more specialised analytics-based services, enabling global organisations to make enduring decisions. This could involve simple solutions such as keeping organizations in touch with the alerts and signals produced by their respective industries as they go through their life cycles. This involves generating valuable information on how the industry is changing, growing, consolidating and keeping an eye on the competition. This helps you, the analyst, to identify and respond to major changes within your macro environment.

With more people and businesses going online everyday, web analytics is poised to become one of the hottest career trends of the next five to 10 years (Gartner). More metrics will be used to measure the effectiveness of an e-business in terms of operations, customer experience and return on investment; web data analysts help enterprises prioritise web channel activities and solutions.

The scope for Analytics

Analytics services have been identified by

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